# SHANMUGA SUNDARAM DEEPIKA

AI Governance Researcher

Singapore • Email • Portfolio • Linkedin


AI Governance researcher with experience advising and working with government leaders and critical-infrastructure operators on technology governance, risks of ecosystem dependence and labour dynamics in Southeast Asia, Japan and Africa.

## Professional Experience

**Gallup** – Strategy Consultant Scope: APAC, Middle East, South & East Africa, Japan Oct 2024 – Feb 2026

- Mapped technology dependencies, vendor lock-ins and structural barriers at a SEA power-generation monopoly via 10 focus groups and interviews across leadership bands and generations, and discourse analysis.
- Co-created a 5-year national financial strategy with Indonesian government leaders, embedding religio-cultural context in local-bank digitalisation and laying foundations for SEA bullion banking infrastructure.
- Co-authored Gallup's Japan workforce whitepaper[1] and led research design for its Singapore counterpart; together they engaged 250+ leaders, including the Singapore government[2], on labour market shifts and adaptation.
- Designed a 30K-record predictive behavioural model in SPSS to identify at-risk priority customers during the digital transformation of 250+ bank branches, informing policy on human-technology touchpoints.
- Managed multi-stakeholder engagements across 7 countries, synthesising data from 109,000+ employees into Board-grade risk assessments presented directly to the C-suite; Rebuilt 3 at-risk Tier 1 APAC partnerships, securing $1.5M.
- Designed a market entry model with executive leaders that captured geopolitical shifts, regulatory risks and government sentiment; secured six-figure HQ funding for replication across APAC.

**Singapore Association for Mental Health, SAMH** – Strategic Engagement Lead Jul – Sep 2023

- Rebuilt performance monitoring across 8 sub-organisations (closed 14 critical KPI misreporting gaps, automated management reporting) and led annual report strategy that lifted donor engagement 30% in a funding downturn.

**Edelman** – Business Intelligence Analyst Jan – Apr 2023

- Analysed 50,000+ data points on policy and stakeholder sentiment to shape market entry and deep-tech investment strategies for energy and healthcare government and private stakeholders.
- Horizon-scanned digital policy trends and designed public repositioning strategies for two priority clients.

**Kids At Risk Action, US** – Head of Research & Institutional Partnerships Jun 2020 – Aug 2022

- Built research pipelines across 3 US universities; designed systems & led the research department during the COVID-19 pandemic, scaling volunteer intake by 230%.
- Convened a 100+ member coalition across government and academia, whose policy briefs were used in lobbying.

## Education

**B.A. Political Science** 2021 - 2024

*National University of Singapore*

- Selected for the University Scholars' Program and Dual Degree Program
- Defended a field research proposal & voter model on political support for criminal candidates in rural India at a PhD seminar
- Ethics-board approved independent study on strategic ambiguity in formal institutions across SEA.

**B.A. International Relations (Specialisation: Middle East)** 2019 - 2021

*Sciences Po (Menton, France)*

- Led a research team on the Ventimiglia (France-Italy) border, published findings on the Refugee situation and cross-border surveillance in the university journal.

## Invited Talks

**Gallup Global Town Hall** – Importance of Compelling Narratives in Cross-Cultural Engagements (~1000+ attendees) 2026

**NUS–Sciences Po 10th Anniversary Commemoration** – Career Readiness & Applying Education in Practice 2026

**Meta, Pass the Vision** – Leadership for Early Graduates 2022

[1] https://www.gallup.com/workplace/695831/japan-spotlight-report.aspx

[2] https://www.gallup.com/workplace/711230/singapore-workplace-report-2026.aspx

## Projects

**Working paper, Applied Research on AI Governance** · *SPSS statistical & discourse analysis* In progress · 2026

- Staffing the State for Frontier AI: Expertise, Capacity, and the Negotiation of Legitimacy.
- Examines the reality of how graduate-trained decision-makers in Singapore negotiate expertise and legitimacy under rapidly evolving institutional standards with the rise of AI in public-sector and implications on state's capacity to govern frontier AI.

**Research & Pilots, Startup** Sep 2026 – Present

- Exploring LLM-based behavioural inference and developing a research-based framework in cognitive health for applications in public healthcare; designing prospective institutional pilots with two public-sector organisations whom have expressed preliminary interest in product.

**Program Lead/ Educator - Independent Education Program** 2019 – 2024

- Built and ran a long-horizon education program for underserved youth in Singapore (11 students), creating customized curricula, progression systems, and accountability structures.

## Teaching & Community Leadership

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| **Program Lead & Educator** – Independent Education Initiative | Jan 2019 – Dec 2024 |
| **Head of Student Advocacy Collective (Gender & Inclusion)** – National University of Singapore | May 2022 – May 2023 |
| **Head of Research & Institutional Partnerships** – Kids At Risk Action, US | Jun 2020 – Aug 2022 |
| **Head of Research** – Amnesty International Sciences Po | May 2020 – May 2021 |
| **Career Readiness Trainer** – Independent Venture (focused on south Asian migrant women in Singapore) | Jan 2020 – Jul 2020 |

## TECHNICAL SKILLS & INTERESTS

**Frameworks & Tools:** Python, R, SPSS, Excel VBA, agentic coding workflows (Claude Code)
**Languages:** English, French, Tamil